“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 13

The Advent of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 May Śrī Caitanyadeva be gracious to me: by His grace even this fallen soul may at once become fit to describe His pastimes.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gauracandra! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory, glory to Nityānanda!

3 Glory, glory to Gadādhara! Glory to Śrīnivāsa (Śrīvāsa)! Glory to Mukunda and Vāsudeva! Glory to Haridāsa!

4 Glory to Svarūpa Dāmodara! Glory to Murāri Gupta! Rising like moons, all of them dispelled the darkness.

5 Glory to the devotees of Śrī Caitanyacandra, who are full moons! The moonlight of their love illumines the three worlds.

6 Thus I have given the preface at the beginning of the book. Now I shall tell of Caitanya’s pastimes in their proper sequence.

7 First I shall list them briefly, as *sūtras* (concise threads); afterwards I shall expand them into a full description.

8 Descending in Navadvīpa, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya enjoyed His pastimes in the manifest world for forty-eight years.

9 His birth is recorded in the Śaka year 1407; His disappearance took place in Śaka 1455.

10 For twenty-four years the Lord lived as a householder, constantly delighting in *kīrtana* all the while.

11 At the end of His twenty-fourth year He took *sannyāsa*, and for another twenty-four years He resided in Nīlācala.

12 Of these, six years were spent in travels—sometimes to the South, sometimes to Gauḍa, sometimes to Vṛndāvana.

13 For eighteen years He stayed in Nīlācala, flooding everyone with the nectar of the pastimes of love for Kṛṣṇa.

14 The Lord's pastimes in household life are called the Ādi-līlā; His final pastimes bear two names—Madhya and Antya.

15 All the Lord's deeds within the Ādi-līlā Murāri Gupta set down in *sūtra* form.

16 The Lord's final pastimes Svarūpa Dāmodara set down as *sūtras* and strung them together in a book.

17 Seeing and hearing the *sūtras* of these two, a Vaiṣṇava describes the pastimes, arranging them in sequence.

18 Childhood, *paugaṇḍa* (boyhood), *kaiśora* (adolescence) and youth —these are four stages; hence the pastimes of the Ādi section fall into four divisions.

19 I praise that full moon of Phālguna, full of every auspicious quality, on which Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya descended together with the names of Kṛṣṇa.

20 The Lord was born at dusk on the full moon of Phālguna; at that very time, by providence, there was an eclipse of the moon.

21 Joyfully the people cried “Hari! Hari!”—Lord Caitanya took birth after first bringing the Name to birth.

22 At His birth and in His childhood, boyhood, adolescence and youth, the Lord made people take the name of Hari on various pretexts.

23 On the pretext of a child’s moods the Lord would cry, and on hearing the names “Kṛṣṇa” and “Hari” He stopped weeping.

24 So the women—all the friends and kinsfolk who came to see Him—would say, “Hari! Hari!”

25 Calling Him “Gaurahari,” all the women laughed; and so His name became Gaurahari.

26 Childhood lasts until the chalk is placed in His hand to begin His schooling; *paugaṇḍa* lasts until He marries.

27 With His marriage came fresh youth; everywhere the Lord made people take up *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, the congregational chanting of the Name.

28 In His *paugaṇḍa* years He studied and taught students, and everywhere He explained the name of Kṛṣṇa.

29 He showed that the purport of every *sūtra*, gloss and commentary is the name of Kṛṣṇa; the students understood it, and it was a wonder to all.

30 To everyone He met He said, “Chant the name of Kṛṣṇa!” He flooded the town of Navadvīpa with the name of Kṛṣṇa.

31 In His *kaiśora* years He began *saṅkīrtana*, dancing in love night and day together with His devotees.

32 Performing *kīrtana*, He wandered from one town to another, and by giving loving devotion He flooded the three worlds.

33 Thus for twenty-four years in Navadvīpa He led all people to love for Kṛṣṇa and to His name.

34 After taking *sannyāsa* He lived twenty-four years more, residing in Nīlācala with His devotees.

35 Of these, for six years He ceaselessly danced, sang and gave loving devotion, setting out from Nīlācala.

36 Preaching love and the Name, He traveled to Setubandha, and through Gauḍa to Vṛndāvana.

37 This is called the Madhya-līlā, the principal abode of His pastimes. The last eighteen years are called the Antya-līlā.

38 For six of these years, with His devotees, He led people to loving devotion amid the delight of dancing and singing.

39 For the last twelve years He remained in Nīlācala and, on the pretext of tasting them Himself, taught the states of love.

40 Night and day the pain of separation from Kṛṣṇa welled up in Him; He behaved like a madman and spoke in delirium.

41 Just as Śrī Rādhā spoke in delirium on seeing Uddhava, so He spoke in mad delirium night and day.

42 Together with Rāmānanda and Svarūpa He relished the songs of Vidyāpati, Jayadeva and Caṇḍīdāsa.

43 Tasting every movement of love in separation from Kṛṣṇa, He fulfilled His own desires.

44 The pastimes of Caitanya are endless. Who, being a tiny soul, could tell them in detail?

45 Even if Ananta Himself were to count them out in brief, with His thousand mouths He would not reach their end.

46 Svarūpa Dāmodara and Murāri Gupta, after careful consideration, wrote down the chief pastimes in *sūtra* form.

47 Following them, I write the *sūtras* of the pastimes; Vṛndāvana dāsa has described them in full.

48 Vṛndāvana dāsa is the Vyāsa of Caitanya's pastimes; he composed his account of them and made them sweet.

49 In whatever places he passed over the pastimes for fear of making his book too long, there I shall give some explanation.

50 He tasted the nectar of the Lord's pastimes; I only chew a little of the remnants of his meal.

51 O devotees, listen: I am writing the *sūtras* of the Ādi-līlā. I write in brief, for it cannot be written in full.

52 To fulfil a certain desire, the prince of Vraja resolved in His mind to descend.

53 First He sent down the circle of His gurus and elders. I tell of them briefly; they cannot be described in full.

54–55 Śrī Śacī and Jagannātha, Śrī Mādhava Purī, Keśava Bhāratī and Śrī Īśvara Purī, Advaita Ācārya and Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, Ācāryaratna, Vidyānidhi and Ṭhākura Haridāsa.

56 A resident of Śrīhaṭṭa named Śrī Upendra Miśra was a Vaiṣṇava—learned, wealthy and foremost in virtue.

57–58 His sons, the seven Miśras, were like seven great sages: Kaṁsāri, Paramānanda, Padmanābha, Sarveśvara, Jagannātha, Janārdana and Trailokyanātha. Jagannātha made his home by the Gaṅgā in Nadīyā.

59 Jagannātha, the best of the Miśras, bore the title Purandara. Formerly he was Nanda and Vasudeva; he was an ocean of good qualities.

60 His wife was named Śacī; she was chaste and devoted to her husband. Her father was Nīlāmbara Cakravartī.

61 Ṭhākura Nityānanda took birth in Rāḍha-deśa; Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, Murāri Gupta and Mukunda also appeared.

62 He caused countless devotees to descend, and last of all the prince of Vraja descended Himself.

63 Before the Lord appeared, all the Vaiṣṇavas used to gather at the home of Advaita Ācārya.

64 Ācārya Gosāñi expounded the *Gītā* and the *Bhāgavata*; condemning the paths of knowledge and *karma*, He proclaimed the greatness of *bhakti*.

65 From all the scriptures He explained devotion to Kṛṣṇa; He accepted nothing else—neither knowledge, nor *yoga*, nor austerity, nor religious duty.

66 In His company the Vaiṣṇavas delighted in talk of Kṛṣṇa, worship of Kṛṣṇa and the congregational chanting of the Name.

67 But seeing all people turned away from Kṛṣṇa and sunk in worldly pursuits, He felt sorrow.

68 He pondered how to deliver the people: “How can all these people be rescued?

69 If Kṛṣṇa descends and spreads *bhakti*, then all people will be delivered.”

70 Vowing to bring Kṛṣṇa down, the Ācārya worshipped Him with *tulasī* and Gaṅgā water.

71 He called Kṛṣṇa with roar upon roar, and the prince of Vraja was drawn by those roars.

72 From the womb of Śacī, the wife of Jagannātha Miśra, eight daughters were born one after another, and each died soon after birth.

73 Grieving at the loss of his children, Miśra worshipped the feet of Viṣṇu, praying for a son.

74 Then a son was born, named Viśvarūpa—greatly virtuous, an abode of Baladeva.

75 Baladeva’s manifestation in the spiritual sky is Saṅkarṣaṇa; He is the material and efficient cause of the universe.

76 Apart from Him I see nothing else in the universe; therefore His name is Viśvarūpa, “He whose form is the universe.”

77 “This is no wonder in the Lord, the unlimited Lord of the universe, on whom this whole world is woven, warp and woof, as a cloth is woven on its threads, O dear king.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.15.35)

78 Therefore the Lord calls him His elder brother. Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma—these two are Caitanya and Nitāi.

79 Having obtained a son, the couple rejoiced and served the feet of Govinda with special devotion.

80 At the end of the month of Māgha in Śaka 1406, Kṛṣṇa entered the bodies of Jagannātha and Śacī.

81 Miśra said to Śacī, “I see something unusual: your body is radiant, and our house seems the dwelling of Lakṣmī.

82 Wherever I go, everyone shows me respect, and people send wealth, cloth and paddy to our house.”

83 Śacī said, “I see beings of divine form come into the sky above and offer praises.”

84 Jagannātha Miśra said, “I had a dream: an effulgent abode entered my heart,

85 and from my heart it passed into yours. From this I understand that some great soul will be born.”

86 Having spoken thus, the two were filled with joy and served the Śālagrāma with special care.

87 The pregnancy went on into its thirteenth month, yet still the child was not born, and Miśra grew afraid.

88 Nīlāmbara Cakravartī calculated and said, “In this month a son will be born at an auspicious moment.”

89 In Śaka 1407, in the month of Phālguna, the auspicious moment came at dusk on the full-moon day.

90 The moon was in Leo, Leo was rising, the planets were exalted; the *ṣaḍ-varga* and the *aṣṭa-varga*—every sign was auspicious.

91 When the spotless moon Gauracandra showed Himself, what further need was there for the spotted moon?

92 Knowing this, Rāhu eclipsed the moon, and the three worlds floated on the names “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa! Hari!”

93 Cries of “Jaya! Jaya!” rose throughout all the worlds; astonished, the people wondered within themselves.

94 Filling the world, the people cried, “Hari! Hari!”—and at that moment Gaura-Kṛṣṇa descended to earth.

95 The heart of the whole world was gladdened; even the Muslims said “Hari” as they laughed at the Hindus.

96 Saying “Hari,” the women raised the auspicious ululation, and in heaven the delighted gods played music and danced.

97 The ten directions grew bright, the waters of the rivers grew clear, and all beings, unmoving and moving, were overwhelmed with bliss.

98 On Nadīyā, the eastern mountain where the moon rises, the full moon Gaurahari rose in His mercy. The darkness of sin was destroyed, the three worlds rejoiced, and the sound of “Hari” filled the world.

99 At that time Advaita Rāya rose up in His own home and danced with a joyful heart. Taking Haridāsa with Him, He delighted in roaring *kīrtana*, and no one knew why He danced.

100 Seeing the eclipse, they laughed, hurried to the bathing place on the Gaṅgā and joyfully bathed. Taking the eclipse as a pretext, Advaita by the power of His mind gave various gifts to the brāhmaṇas.

101 Seeing the whole world full of bliss, Haridāsa marveled and said in hints, “This merriment of Yours gladdens my heart. I see there is some purpose behind it.”

102 Ācāryaratna and Śrīvāsa were delighted at heart. They went and bathed in the waters of the Gaṅgā; overwhelmed with joy, they sang *hari-saṁkīrtana* and by the power of the mind gave various gifts.

103 In the same way all the devotees and renunciants, wherever they lived, danced and sang *saṁkīrtana* where they were, overwhelmed with joy, and on the pretext of the eclipse gave gifts by the power of the mind.

104 The wives of brāhmaṇas and of respectable men came, bringing gifts on trays filled with various articles. Seeing the child’s form, lustrous like pure gold, they gave their blessings with delight.

105 Sāvitrī, Gaurī, Sarasvatī, Śacī, Rambhā, Arundhatī and all the other heavenly women filled trays with various articles, assumed the dress of brāhmaṇa women and came to see Him.

106 In the sky the gods, Siddhas, Gandharvas and Cāraṇas offered praises, danced, played and sang. The dancers, musicians and bards whose stage was Navadvīpa all came and danced with delight.

107 Who came and who went, who danced and who sang—no one could make out anyone's words. Sorrow and grief were gone, the people were filled with delight, and Miśra was overwhelmed with joy.

108 Ācāryaratna and Śrīnivāsa came to Jagannātha Miśra and reminded him of his duties. They had the birth ceremony performed according to the prescribed rules, and then Miśra gave many gifts.

109 All the gifts he had received and whatever there was in the house—all that wealth he gave away to the brāhmaṇas; and he honored all the dancers, singers, bards and the destitute with gifts.

110 Śrīvāsa's wife, named Mālinī, together with Ācāryaratna's wife and the other women, joyfully worshipped the child, offering vermilion, turmeric, oil, puffed rice, bananas and various fruits.

111 Advaita Ācārya's wife, the noble lady worshipped by the world, named Sītā Ṭhākurāṇī, received the Ācārya's permission and went with gifts to see the crest-jewel of children.

112 She brought golden bangles, foot ornaments of silver coins, golden armlets and wristlets, fine conch-shell bangles for both arms, silver anklets and various necklaces of gold coins;

113 a tiger's claw set in gold, a waist cord of silk thread, all kinds of ornaments for the hands and feet, colorful silk sārīs, a knitted child's frock with a silk border, and much wealth in gold and silver coins.

114 Filling trays with auspicious articles—*dūrvā* grass, paddy, *gorocana*, turmeric, *kuṅkuma* and sandalwood—and baskets with clothes and ornaments, she rode in a curtained palanquin, taking her maidservants with her.

115 She brought many loads of foods and dishes as gifts and arrived at Śacī's house. In the child's form she saw Kānu of Gokula Himself—only His color was different.

116 All His limbs were beautifully formed and shone like a golden image; all were full of auspicious marks. Seeing the child's divine effulgence, she felt great joy, and her heart melted with motherly love.

117 She placed *dūrvā* grass and paddy on His head and gave many blessings: "May both brothers live long!" Fearing witches and evil spirits, she named Him "Nimāi."

118 On the day of the mother's purificatory bath she gave clothes and ornaments, honoring Miśra together with his son. Accepting the honor offered by Śacī and Miśra, Sītā Ṭhākurāṇī returned home, joyful at heart.

119 Thus Śacī and Jagannātha, having obtained as their son the Lord of Lakṣmī, had all their desires fulfilled. Their house was filled with wealth and grain; honored by all, they grew happier day by day.

120 Miśra was a Vaiṣṇava—peaceful, free from lust, pure and self-controlled—and took no pride in enjoying wealth. Whatever wealth came to him by his son's power he gave to the brāhmaṇas for the pleasure of Viṣṇu.

121 Having calculated the ascendant, Nīlāmbara Cakravartī joyfully told Miśra in private, "I see the various signs of a great personality in His ascendant and on His body. He will deliver the world."

122 Thus the Lord mercifully descended in Śacī's house. Whoever hears of it—to him the merciful Lord Gaura becomes kind, and he attains His feet.

123 One who has obtained a human birth yet does not hear of Gaura's qualities has wasted such a birth. He has found a river of nectar yet drinks water from a poisonous pit—having been born, why did he not die?

124 Honoring on his head, as his own treasure, the holy feet of Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda, Ācārya Advaitacandra, Svarūpa, Rūpa and Raghunātha dāsa, Kṛṣṇadāsa has sung the pastime of the Lord's birth.